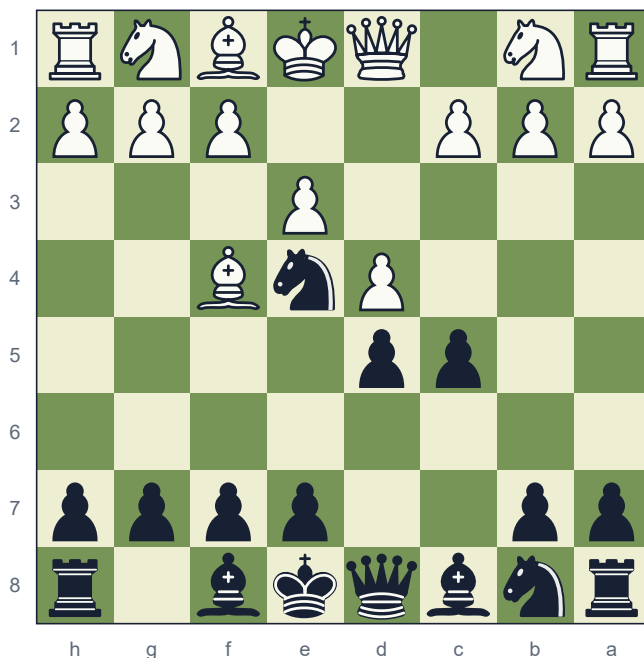


Trompowsky Veresov and early deviations

1. d4 Nf6 2. Bg5 Ne4 3. Bf4 d5 4. e3 c5

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use explicit companion lines when a King's Indian setup would concede an easy center or ignore a threat. The repertoire chooses ...d5 against 2.Nc3, avoiding an obligatory Pirc.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

An early Bg5 changes the knight's freedom. An early Nc3 supports e4 without c4. These positions require their own plans.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may double your pawns, seize e4, or use Nb5 and Bf4 to attack c7. The aim is active development and concrete central control.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Do not play ...g6 as a universal second move.
2. Recognize the Pirc boundary.
3. Verify whether a sacrifice is actually sound.

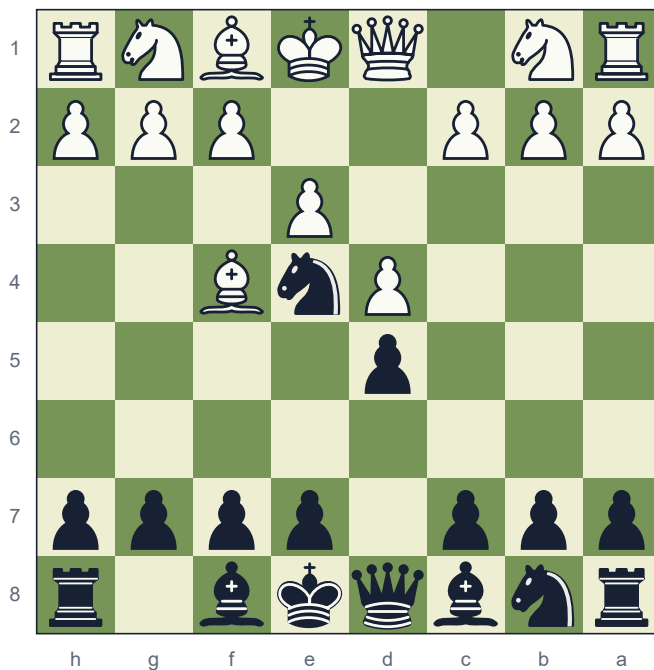
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Trompowsky: question the bishop with ...Ne4

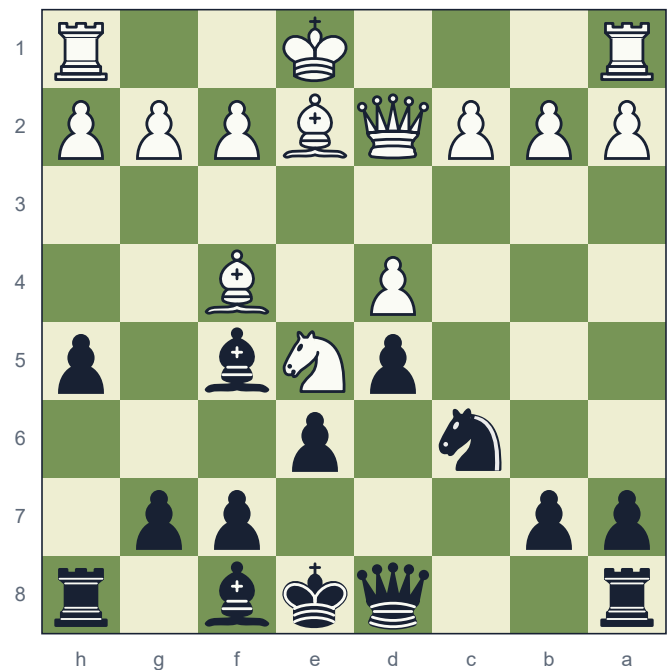
STUDY LINE 20-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. Bg5 Ne4 3. Bf4 d5 4. e3 c5 5. Nd2 Nxd2 6. Qxd2 cxd4 7. exd4 Bf5 8. Nf3 Nc6 9. Ne5 h5
10. Be2 e6

Selected anchor ends with 4... c5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 4... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...Ne4 attacks Bg5. ...d5 supports central space and ...c5 challenges d4 before White establishes a quiet setup.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the queenside and choose how to maintain or exchange the e4 knight. White may play f3 to drive it back.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The knight on e4 can become a target. Do not spend more tempi defending it than its activity is worth.

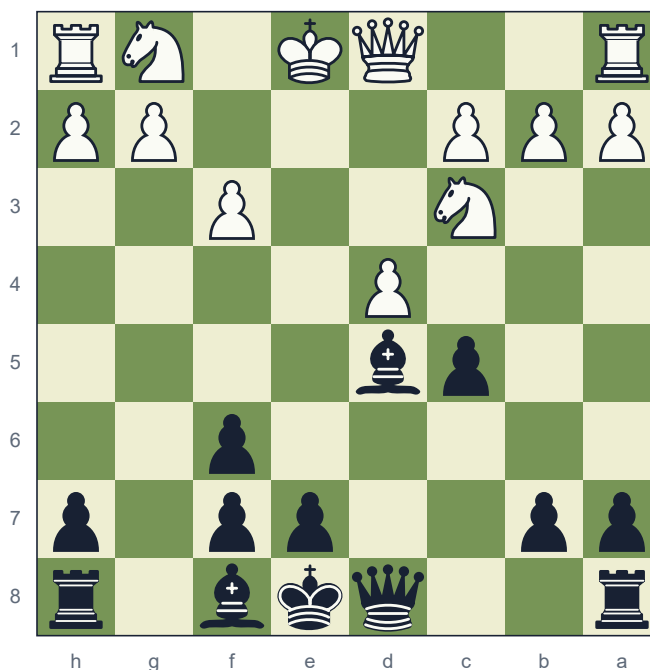
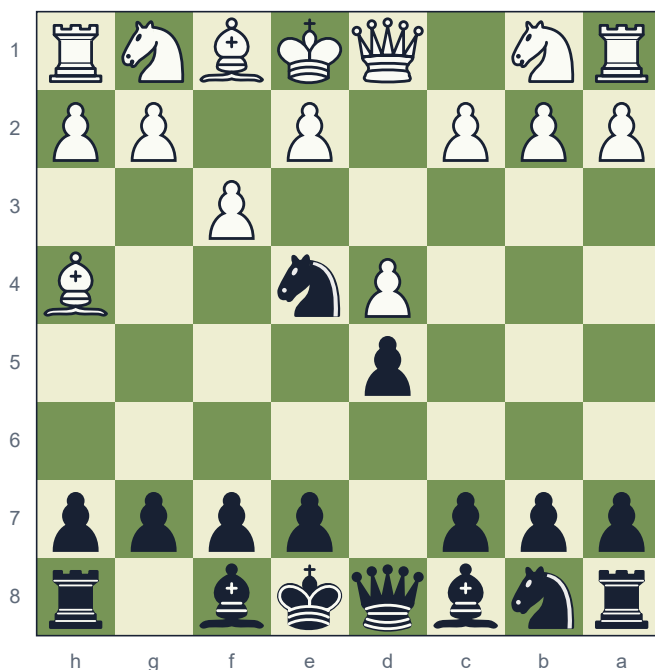
REMEMBER Active central play replaces the fianchetto script.

02 Trompowsky: the bishop retreats to h4

STUDY LINE 20-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. Bg5 Ne4 3. Bh4 d5 4. f3 Nf6 5. Nc3 c5 6. e4 Nc6 7. Bb5 Bd7 8. Bxc6 Bxc6 9. Bxf6 gxf6 10. exd5 Bxd5

Selected anchor ends with 4... Nf6. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White spends f3 to challenge the knight. Returning to f6 is sound development logic: Black has induced a pawn move that blocks Nf3.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop ...c5 or ...Bf5 according to the center. White may build e4, so challenge the space before it settles.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not cling to e4 when the retreat completes a useful exchange of tempi.

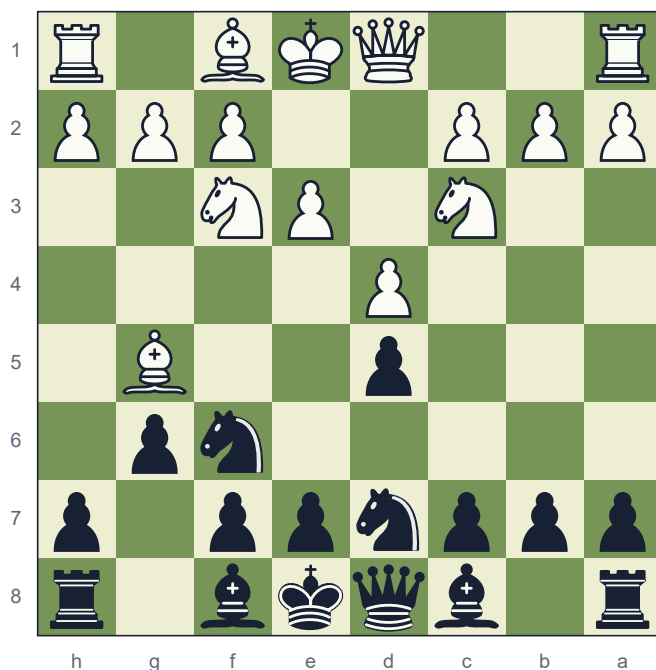
REMEMBER A retreat can preserve the benefits of an early sortie.

03 Veresov: Nc3 and Bg5

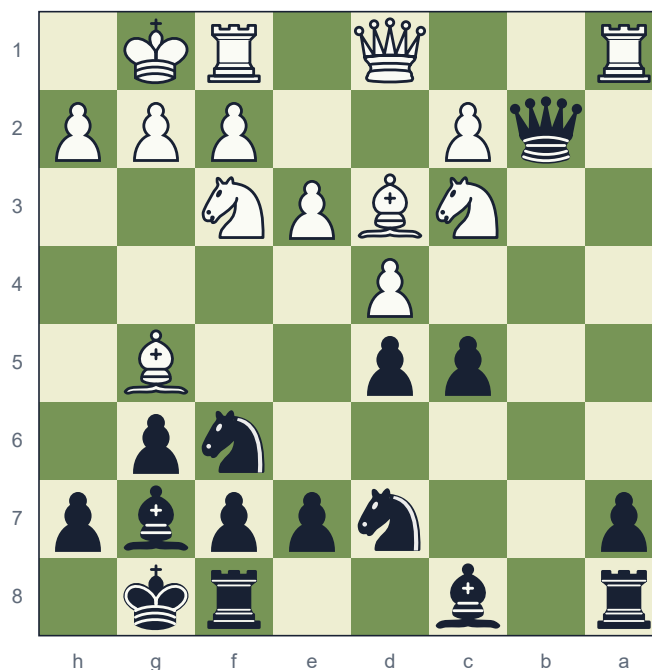
STUDY LINE 20-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nc3 d5 3. Bg5 Nbd7 4. Nf3 g6 5. e3 Bg7 6. a4 O-O 7. a5 c5 8. Bd3 b6 9. axb6 Qxb6 10. O-O Qxb2

Selected anchor ends with 5... Bg7. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 5... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...d5 prevents a free e4 center. ...Nbd7 develops behind the pin and supports central squares.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Castle and prepare ...c5 or ...e5 with support. White may exchange on f6 or push e4.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

This is a Veresov structure, not the d6/e5 King's Indian chain.

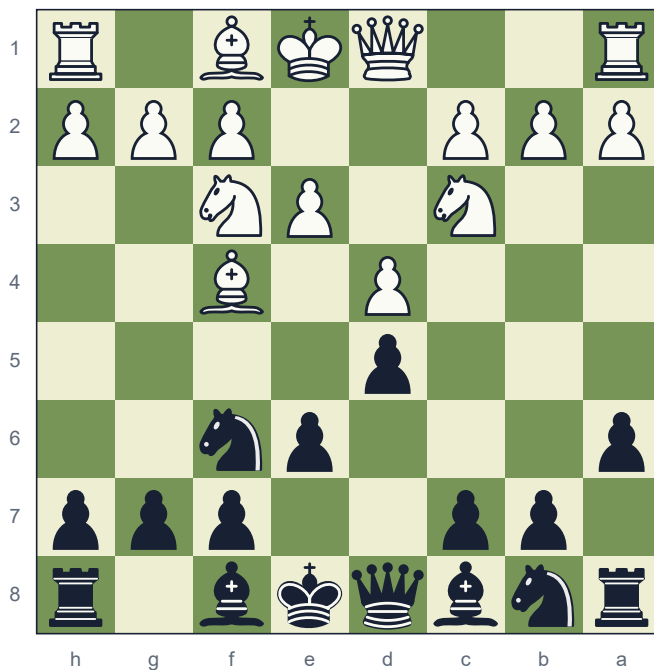
REMEMBER Use the central structure you actually have.

04 Jobava: Bf4 and the Nb5 threat

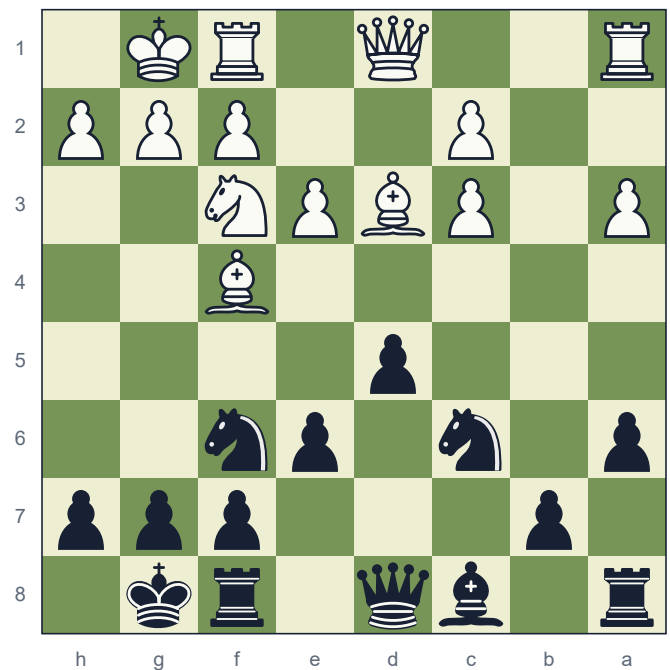
STUDY LINE 20-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nc3 d5 3. Bf4 a6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 c5 6. dxc5 Bxc5 7. Bd3 Nc6 8. O-O Bb4 9. a3 Bxc3 10. bxc3 O-O

Selected anchor ends with 5... c5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 5... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...a6 prevents Nb5 from attacking c7. Black then challenges d4 and develops a normal central game.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Complete ...Nc6 and ...Be7 or ...Bd6 as appropriate. Count the e4 break and bishop exchanges.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Ignoring Nb5 can force awkward concessions. A modest pawn move can answer a specific threat.

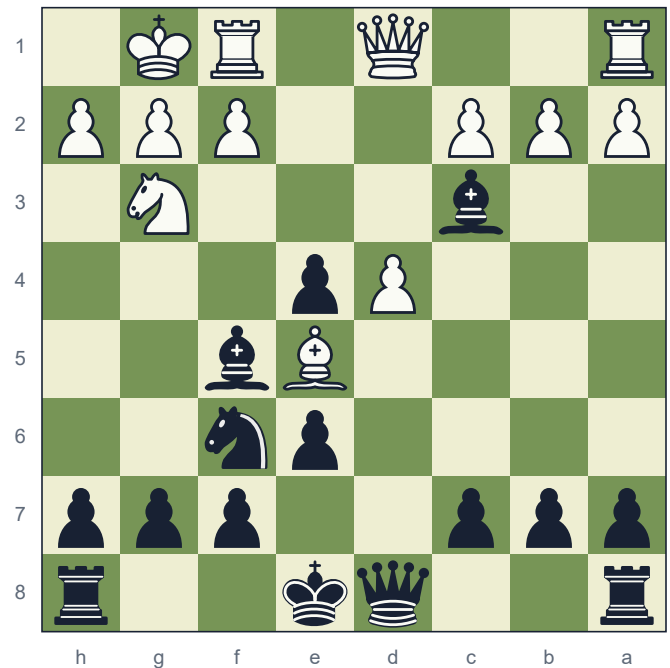
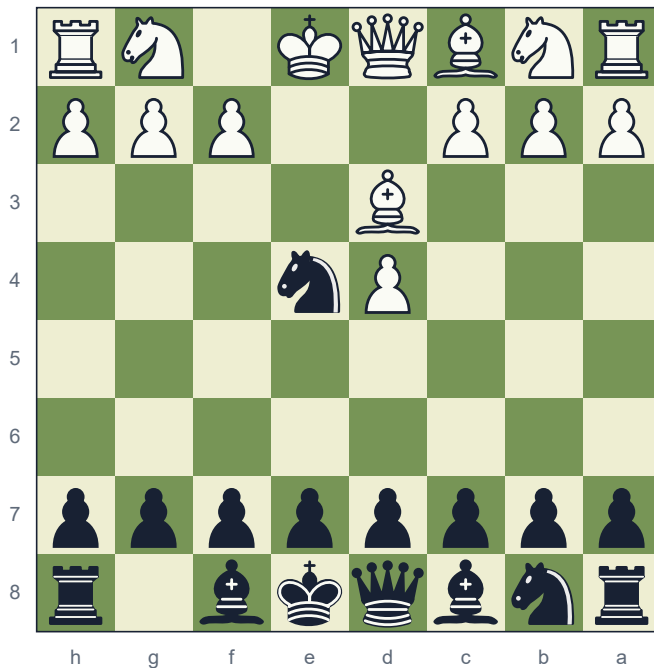
REMEMBER Prevent the concrete jump, then develop actively.

05 An immediate 2.e4 pawn offer

STUDY LINE 20-05

1. d4 Nf6 2. e4 Nxe4 3. Bd3 d5 4. Bxe4 dxe4 5. Nc3 Bf5 6. Nge2 e6 7. Bf4 Nd7 8. Ng3 Bb4 9. O-O Nf6 10. Be5 Bxc3

Selected anchor ends with 3... d5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

Black accepts the unprotected e4 pawn, then supports the knight while claiming central space. White receives development chances for the pawn.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop safely and return material if necessary to complete development. Watch checks and attacks on the knight.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

An extra pawn does not excuse repeated knight moves or an unsafe king.

REMEMBER Accept material, then finish development.

Review before your next game

